

struggling with – doing work that I was proud of. I was being vulnerable, finally able to be truly myself in my work, and helping others in the course of doing so – but I had to be able to find a way to make a living too. This felt particularly sensitive because of the subject matter of my work, and sure enough, the first accusations of being a sell-out materialized on the Instagram post where I announced the impending publication of my first book, *Real Life Money*. I grappled with my conscience every time I posted about my book, worrying that people would think I was a hypocrite, or that I was just trying to make money from the vulnerable people in my audience. At the same time, when I started writing for publications and negotiating brand and advertising partnerships, I worried that this too constituted selling out. Some deals were far more lucrative than any work I'd ever done before, and I would squeamishly compare the rates with the days and weeks I would have had to work to earn that much in my old job. I worried about getting an overblown sense of my own value, and what the consequences of that might be. The whole thing really made me confront and consider a lot of the assumptions and beliefs that I had about money, and the way that I moralized earning what I considered to be a fortune.

As time has moved on, I've become more comfortable with this new way of working and earning, and I've worked hard to separate my sense of self-worth from the money that I earn. One of the things that has helped is the fact that my husband works in a very different, employed role. Until very